

Analytics & Metrics

Part of **Digital Marketing Essentials** · Estimated time: 30 min

Introduction

A marketing dashboard can show dozens of numbers at once — the skill isn't knowing all of them, it's knowing which ones actually connect to a decision you're able to make.

Core ideas

- A vanity metric looks impressive (total page views, follower count) but rarely changes what you'd do next; an actionable metric is tied to a specific decision.
- Conversion rate — the percentage of visitors who complete a goal — often matters more than raw traffic, since more visitors who don't convert isn't actually progress.
- Metrics only mean something compared against a baseline or a goal — "1,000 visitors" is meaningless without knowing what last month, or your target, looked like.
- A spike in traffic isn't automatically good news — it matters where it came from and whether those visitors did anything once they arrived.

Try it yourself

Look at any analytics dashboard you have access to (a website, a social account). Pick one vanity metric and one actionable metric you can see, and write one sentence on what decision the actionable metric could actually inform.

Further reading

- [Google Analytics Academy](https://analytics.google.com/analytics/academy/)

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- [CXL — Actionable Metrics vs. Vanity Metrics](https://cxl.com/blog/actionable-metrics/)

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